

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 19

GUPTA DYNASTY
PART - 2

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS



GUPTA DYNASTY

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

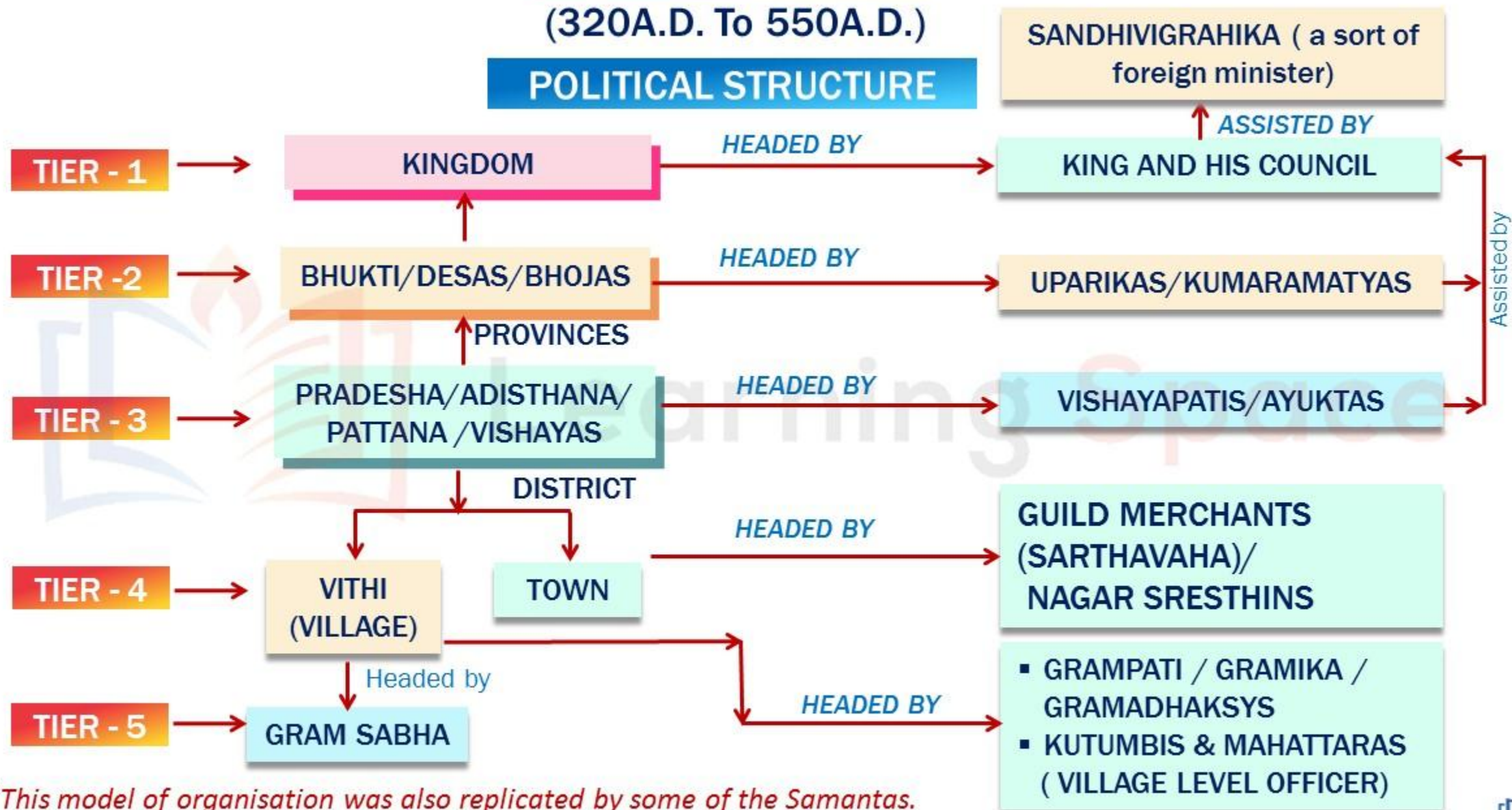
HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

POLITICAL STRUCTURE



✓ This model of organisation was also replicated by some of the Samantas.

GUPTA EMPIRE

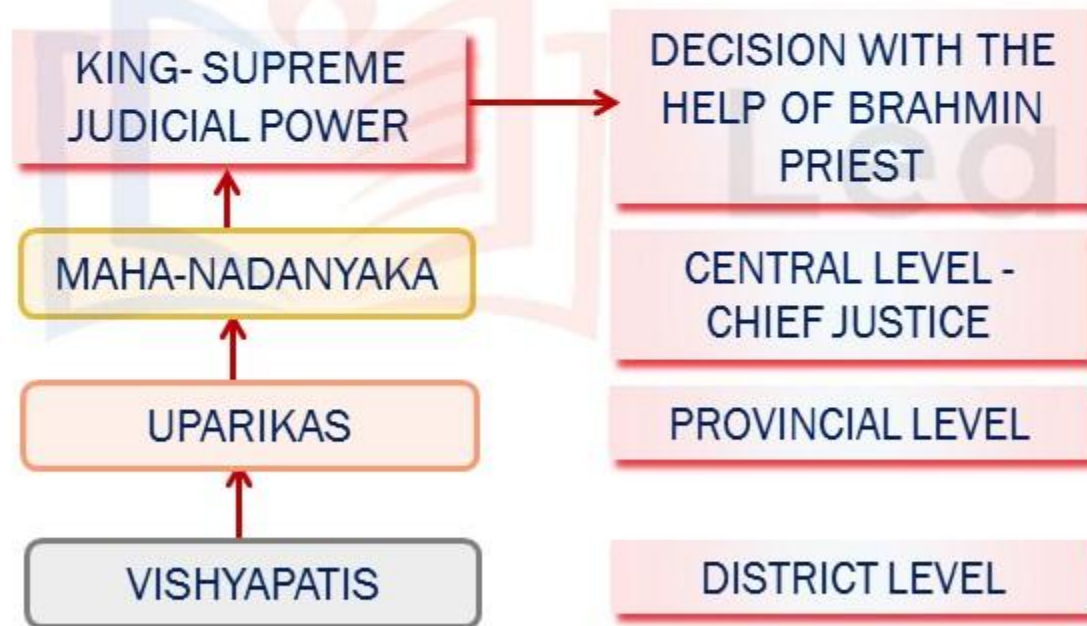
(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

POLITICAL STRUCTURE

JUDICIAL STRUCTURE

The judicial system was far more developed under the Gupta rulers than in earlier times.

LEVEL OF JUDICIARY



LEGAL SYSTEM

- Elaborate **laws were laid down**.
- Laws were based on the Varna hierarchy.
- For the first time, **civil and criminal laws** were clearly demarcated

CIVIL LAW

- Like disputes regarding property

CRIMINAL LAW

- Like theft and adultery.

The guilds of merchants and artisans were governed by their own laws and capital punishment was not at all given (as reported by Fa-Hien).

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

NATURE OF GUPTA ADMINISTRATION



GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

POLITICAL STRUCTURE

SEEDS OF INDIAN FEUDALISM

Land grants were prevalent in post-Vedic period in its infancies.

However, it became widespread under Satavahanas in Deccan, Shakas in western India, and Pallavas in south India.

This system of the land grants got further accelerated in Post-Gupta period and created ideal conditions for development of Indian feudalism.

However, Guptas went one step ahead and made land grants a substantive part of discharge of their responsibilities.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

POLITICAL STRUCTURE

SEEDS OF INDIAN FEUDALISM

GUPTA'S LAND GRANTS - THREE TYPES OF GRANTS

1

RELIGIOUS GRANTS

First was the **religious grants** to *brahmans*, individually or collectively, known as *brahmadeya* Grants

2

INSTITUTIONAL GRANTS

Second was the **grants to institutions** such as temples and monasteries known as *devagrahara* or *devadana*.

3

SECULAR GRANTS

Third were **secular grants** to crown officers, craft guilds or also military commanders in rare occasions.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

POLITICAL STRUCTURE

SEEDS OF INDIAN FEUDALISM

SAMANTA SYSTEM- DECENTRALISATION AND DEVOLUTION OF POWER

GUPTAS FEUDATORY SYSTEM WAS ALSO KNOWN AS SAMANTA SYSTEM

Samantas is the name given to **tributary kings or landed chiefs** who were granted a piece of land by the King in return for their allegiance to the crown and had to perform mandatory military duties whenever called upon by the King to serve.

Implications of Decentralization

1. Gupta policy of devolution of power helped to **create layers of responsibility in the governance.**
2. It allowed **self-governing communities.**
3. As Samantas gained power they themselves called as Mahamandelshwara.

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

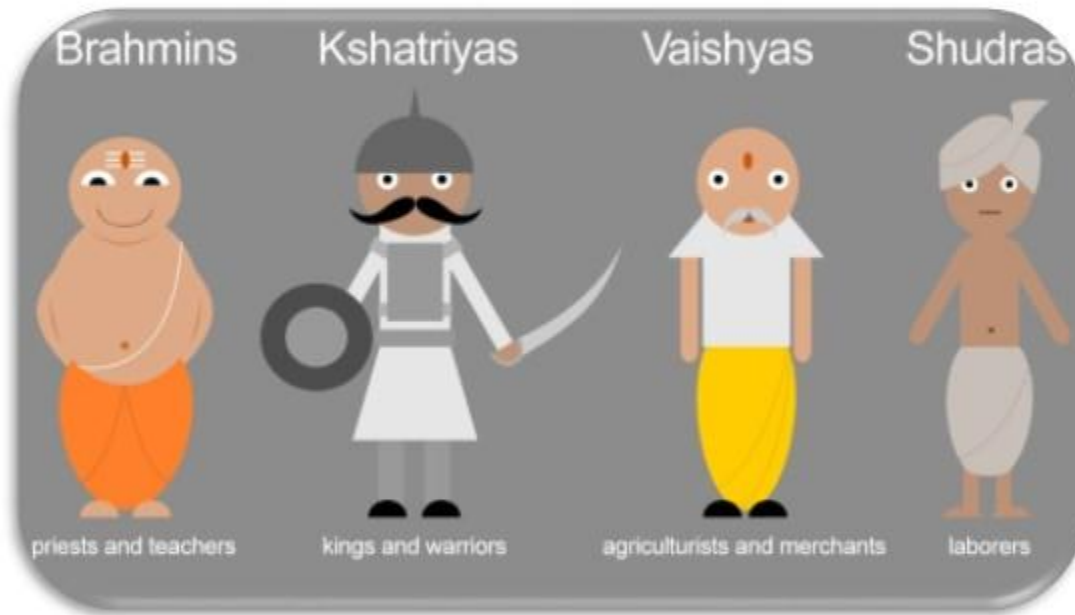
OTHER FACTS

GUPTA EMPIRE

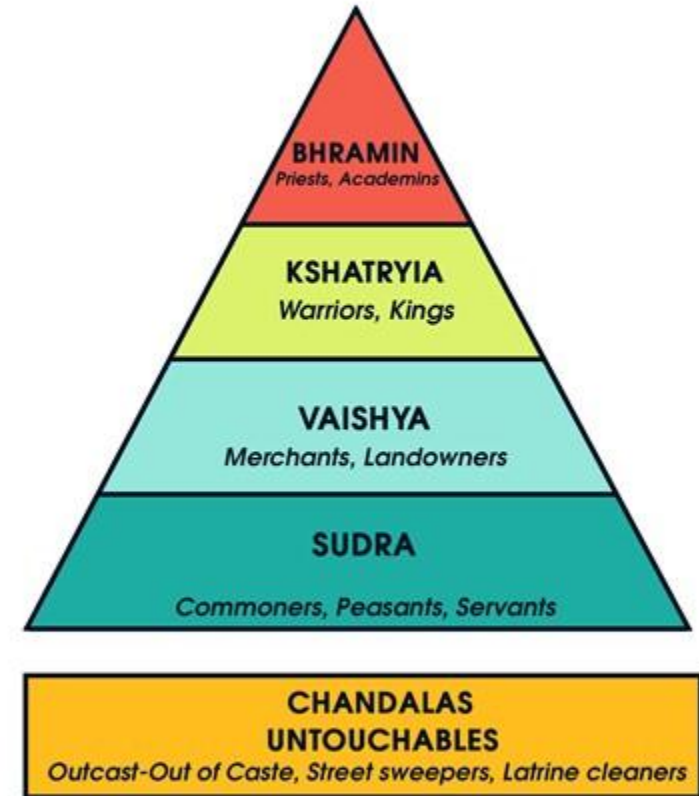
(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

1 CASTE SYSTEM



SOCIAL SYSTEM PRE-GUPTA



SOCIAL SYSTEM DURING GUPTA

Concept of purity and pollution emerged.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

1 CASTE SYSTEM- THREE SIGNIFICANT FEATURES



- 1 There was weakening of the links between caste and its occupation.

INDICATION OF MOBILITY AND FLUIDITY

- 2 There are records of Brahmins and Kshatriyas adopting occupations of lower castes and Vaishyas and shudras of upper castes.
- 3 Condition of Shudras improved. They became farmers and upgraded themselves into sharecroppers
- 4 That is, it allowed other caste to make some progress.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

1 CASTE SYSTEM- THREE SIGNIFICANT FEATURES



- 1 Practice of untouchability began and their condition reached nadir.

STATUS OF NEW CASTE- CHANDALAS

- 2 Fahien mentions that Chandalas were segregated from the society and forced to live outside their villages and engaged in demeaning occupation.
- 3 Untouchables had to sound a clapper in the streets so that the upper caste people could be warned of his presence.
- 4 Upper caste even need to take a ritual bath in the event of close proximity with an untouchable.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

1 CASTE SYSTEM- THREE SIGNIFICANT FEATURES



ACCULTURATION

- 1 Accelerated the **detrribalization**- the **hitherto isolated tribal groups** were brought into the caste system due to
 - ✓ increased political decentralization
 - ✓ liberal land grants
- 2 Acculturation of foreign groups- remnants of existing **foreign groups** such as Shakas, Yavanas, Kushanas were brought into caste system.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

2 STATUS OF WOMEN

The position of women had become miserable.

They were prohibited from studying the religious texts like the Puranas.

Sati was practiced.

Manusmriti suggested the early marriage for girls, accordingly it was practiced in society.

The practice of *Swyamvara* was given up - i.e practice of choosing a husband among a list of able men

However, caste endogamy was not much rigid now as compared to earlier times- Anuloma and Pratiloma was acknowledged.

Hypergamy (Anuloma)

Marriage of a high caste man with a low caste woman

Hypogamy (Pratiloma)

Marriage of a low caste man with a high caste woman

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

3 RELIGION IN GUPTA PERIOD

BRAHMANISM

- **Brahmanism** reigned supreme.
- It had two branches - **Vaishnavism** and **Saivism** (roots of Bhaktism).
- Most of the Gupta kings were Vaishnavites.
- **Puranas** were composed



BUDDHISM

Buddhism was generally prevalent in **Northern** India including Kashmir, Afghanistan and Swat Valley.



Both Buddhism and Hinduism received support and the Gupta Kings were perfectly tolerant.

GUPTA EMPIRE

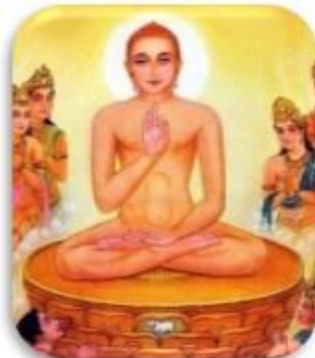
(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

3 RELIGION IN GUPTA PERIOD

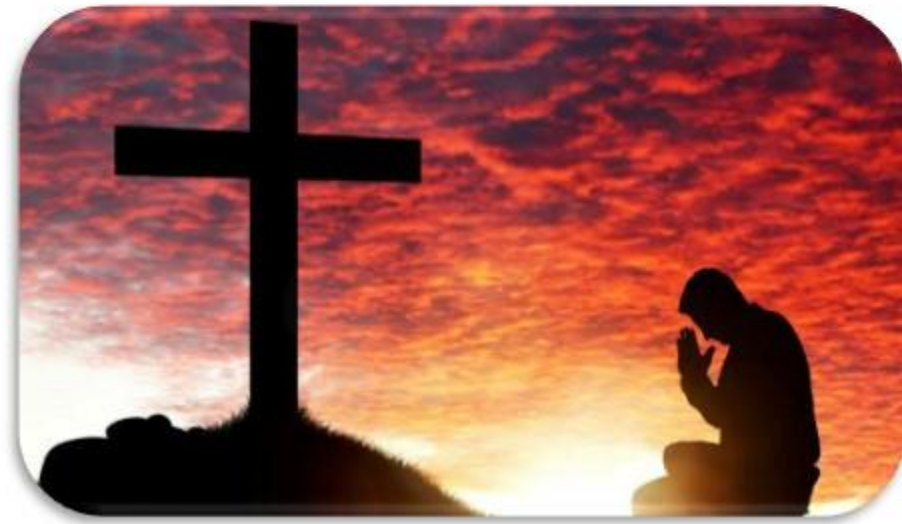
JAINISM

- Did not attain much popularity
- Was **confined to the merchant communities** of west and South India.
- The great Jain Council was held at Valabhi and Jain Canon of the Svetambras was written.



CHRISTIANITY

Christianity had also arrived in India but it was confined to the Malabar Region.



Q & A

Q.1 With reference to Indian history, which of the following is/are the essential element/elements of the feudal system?

1. A very strong centralised political authority and a very weak provincial or local political authority.
2. Emergence of administrative structure based on control and possession of land.
3. Creation of lord-vassal relationship between the feudal lord and his overlord.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER

b)

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

L. V. Krishna

Y. Deepthi

Y. Prema Manvi

S. Manoj Kumar

Mayank Chaudhary

D. Shruti Reddy

G. Ravi Babu

K. Victor Babu

D. Joji

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9